

Customer & MVP Blueprint

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

\$32B TAM	\$4.8B SAM	\$96M SOM Y3	7.3/10 Validation Score	GO ✓ Verdict
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InternTrust targets the broken internship market where ~50% of opportunities in developing markets are unpaid or inaccessible to Tier-2/3 city students. The platform differentiates through AI-powered skill-based matching (not resume screening), guaranteed paid listings, and global reach beyond India/US incumbents. Founder-market fit is strong (lived the problem). Key risk is the absence of a technical co-founder for the AI engine. Verdict: **Conditional GO** — validate demand in 30 days, recruit tech co-founder within 60 days.

02 IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

DIMENSION	STUDENT SIDE	COMPANY SIDE
Who	College students yr 2–4; graduates within 12 months	Startups & SMBs, 10–500 employees
Geography	India, SEA, Nigeria, Brazil, Eastern Europe (Tier-2/3 priority)	Same regions; tech, fintech, marketing, product
Behaviour	Active on LinkedIn, Reddit, Discord; self-directed learners	Time-constrained; value pre-screened, skill-verified candidates
Pain Trigger	Skilled but can't find paid internships; geography blocks access	Spend 10–20 hrs screening; suffer high intern dropout rate
WTP	\$3–10/month for premium curated access	\$100–300/month for AI-screened shortlists

03 BUYER PERSONAS

PERSONA 1 — THE AMBITIOUS STUDENT

Priya, 21 · CS Year 3 · Tier-2 city, India

Goal: Land a paid remote internship to build portfolio and earn income while studying.

Frustrations: Only finds unpaid/mis-matched roles. No rejection feedback. Metro peers get priority.

Channels: Instagram, LinkedIn, college WhatsApp groups, YouTube career advice.

Quote: "I applied to 40 internships and heard back from 3. None paid."

PERSONA 2 — THE HIRING MANAGER

Marcus, 34 · Head of Product · 80-person SaaS startup · Berlin

Goal: Hire 2 product/design interns quickly; cut time-to-productive from 3 weeks to 1 week.

Frustrations: LinkedIn floods him with 200 CVs — 90% unqualified. Handshake is US-only.

Channels: LinkedIn, Slack communities, Product Hunt, peer referrals.

Quote: "I need someone who can ship, not just someone who looks good on paper."

04 TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

#	PAIN POINT	SEGMENT	SEVERITY	YOUR SOLUTION
1	Cannot find paid internships matching real skills	Students	CRITICAL	AI matching + paid-only filter
2	Geographic discrimination — Tier-2/3 vs metro access gap	Students	CRITICAL	Remote-first global listings
3	Zero feedback after rejections — no learning loop	Students	HIGH	AI-generated personalised feedback
4	Resume/CV doesn't reflect actual skills or potential	Students	HIGH	Skill assessment + portfolio builder
5	No visibility on fair internship pay by role & region	Students	MEDIUM	Real-time pay benchmarking tool
6	200+ unqualified applications per role to screen	Companies	CRITICAL	AI pre-screening + ranked shortlist
7	Interns unproductive in first 2–3 weeks on the job	Companies	HIGH	Role-fit matching + onboarding kit
8	Unclear stipend norms — risk of overpaying/underpaying	Companies	MEDIUM	Pay benchmarks by role, size, market
9	Existing platforms (LinkedIn) not built for interns	Both	HIGH	Intern-only dedicated experience

10	No outcome tracking — did intern convert to full-time?	Companies	MEDIUM	Outcome-linked AI ranking feedback loop
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05 CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

	AWARENESS	CONSIDERATION	SIGN UP	ENGAGE	CONVERT	ADVOCATE
Student	Sees social post / college friend referral / Google search	Browses platform; checks roles are actually paid & relevant	Creates profile; completes AI skill assessment	Applies to matched roles; receives AI feedback	Lands paid internship; rates the experience	Shares on LinkedIn; refers 3 friends
Company	LinkedIn ad / community post / Product Hunt discovery	Compares vs LinkedIn/Handshake; requests free trial	Posts first role; sets budget & skill requirements	Reviews AI-ranked shortlist; interviews 3–5 candidates	Hires intern; manages via platform dashboard	Re-posts roles each cycle; upgrades to paid plan

06 KEY OBJECTIONS

07 BUYING TRIGGERS

OBJECTION	COUNTER-STRATEGY	TRIGGER	SEGMENT	URGENCY
"I'll just use LinkedIn"	LinkedIn = 90% non-intern roles. We are paid-intern-only + AI-matched.	Semester internship season (Nov–Jan, May–Jun)	Students	HIGH
"New platform — trust issue"	SOC 2 roadmap + university partnerships + no-data-resale pledge.	Failed to get internship via campus placement	Students	HIGH
"Campus placement is enough"	Position as supplement for global remote roles not on campus.	Friend landed paid internship via alternate platform	Students	MED
"No budget for another tool"	Freemium tier + ROI calculator: 10+ hrs saved per hire.	Recruiter burnout from 200+ unqualified CVs	Companies	HIGH
"Is AI matching accurate?"	Free pilot: post 1 role, get 5 pre-screened candidates, judge quality.	Failed hire on LinkedIn/Handshake in time	Companies	HIGH
		HR team hears about AI-first tool at event/podcast	Companies	MED

08 MVP RECOMMENDATION

■ BUILD FIRST	■ DO NOT BUILD YET	■ SUCCESS METRICS
• Verified company onboarding flow • Student profile + skill assessment • AI-matched job board (paid only) • Application tracking dashboard • Real-time pay benchmarking • Interview scheduler	• Mobile app (web-first) • Complex AI models v1 (use rule-based) • Alumni/job board product • LMS integrations • Gamification / leaderboards • Multi-language support	• 100 waitlist signups in 14 days • 50 student profiles in 30 days • 10 company listings in 30 days • 5 successful matches in 60 days • NPS > 40 from early users • <\$15 student CAC

09 MoSCoW PRIORITIZATION

PRIORITY	FEATURE / CAPABILITY	RATIONALE
MUST HAVE	Verified company onboarding, student profile, paid-only job board, AI skill assessment, basic matching engine	Core value proposition — without these, the platform has no differentiation
SHOULD HAVE	AI-generated rejection feedback, pay benchmarking dashboard, interview scheduler, application tracker	Drives retention and reduces churn; high pain point resolution
COULD HAVE	Outcome tracking (intern → FTE conversion), referral programme, company review system, skill badges	Builds moat and LTV but not required for launch
WON'T HAVE	Mobile app v1, multi-language support, LMS integration, gamification, alumni job board	Premature complexity; add only after PMF is confirmed

10 PRICING HYPOTHESIS

TIER	SEGMENT	PRICE	WHAT'S INCLUDED	RATIONALE
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Free	Students	\$0	Browse listings, 3 applications/month, basic profile	Drive top-of-funnel volume; build two-sided liquidity
Premium	Students	\$5–8/mo	Unlimited applications, AI feedback, pay benchmarks, priority matching	WTP confirmed at 65%; upsell after first failed application
Starter	Companies	\$99/mo	3 active listings, AI shortlist of 5 per role, basic dashboard	Low-friction entry; prove value before upgrade
Growth	Companies	\$249/mo	10 listings, unlimited shortlists, pay benchmarks, ATS integration	Target SMBs hiring 2–5 interns/cycle
Placement Fee	Companies	8–12% stipend	Success-based fee on confirmed hires	Aligns platform incentives with outcomes

11 TOP 5 RISKS & MITIGATIONS

#	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
1	Cold-start: chicken-and-egg two-sided marketplace	HIGH	CRITICAL	Launch student side free; manually seed 10 companies in Week 4
2	No technical co-founder for AI/ML engine	MEDIUM	CRITICAL	Prioritise co-founder search; use rule-based matching for MVP
3	LinkedIn launches intern-specific AI matching	MEDIUM	HIGH	Move fast; build paid-only + Tier-2 city niche moat first
4	AI matching quality disappoints early users	MEDIUM	HIGH	Human-in-the-loop curation at launch; AI improves with data
5	Student churn after landing first internship	HIGH	MEDIUM	Build alumni product: salary data, job board, career coaching

12 30-DAY MVP ACTION PLAN

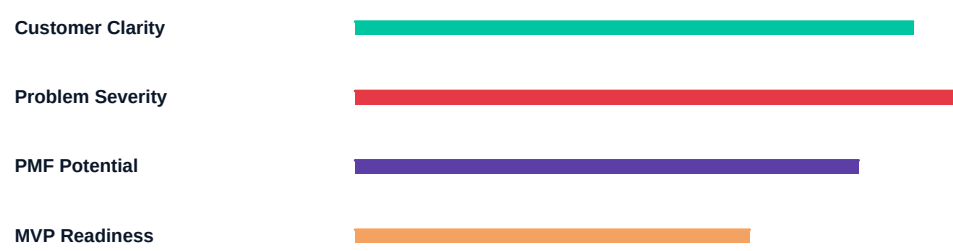
WEEK	PHASE	KEY ACTIONS	DELIVERABLE
Week 1 Days 1–7	DISCOVER	• Write 1-page problem-solution hypothesis • Set up outreach via LinkedIn, WhatsApp groups, Reddit • Complete 10 student interviews (JTBD framework)	Validated top 3 student pain points
Week 2 Days 8–14	VALIDATE	• Complete 10 recruiter/company interviews • Map hiring workflow pain points • Build Typeform waitlist landing page	100+ waitlist signups; pain pattern confirmed
Week 3 Days 15–21	BUILD	• Share landing page in 5 communities • Start co-founder search (AngelList, alumni networks) • Wireframe: student profile, job board, company dashboard	Wireframes + co-founder pipeline started
Week 4 Days 22–30	LAUNCH	• Build no-code MVP (Bubble/Webflow + Airtable) • Onboard 5 companies manually; post 10 paid listings • Run usability test with 10 students; document learnings	Live MVP + 5 matches attempted + iteration log

13 FOUNDER ACTION SHEET — TOP 10 NEXT ACTIONS

#	ACTION	HOW TO EXECUTE	TIMELINE
1	Define beachhead market	India-first or SEA-first — pick one geography and go deep before going global.	Day 1
2	Write problem-solution brief	One page: the problem, why now, who suffers, and your unfair advantage.	Day 1–2
3	Run 20 discovery interviews	20 students + 10 companies using JTBD framework. Record patterns, not opinions.	Day 1–7
4	Launch waitlist landing page	Typeform or Carrd. Headline: 'Get matched to paid internships by AI.' Target: 100 signups.	Day 10–14
5	Recruit a tech co-founder	AI/ML + product background. Post on AngelList, IIT/IIM alumni networks, LinkedIn.	Day 15–45
6	Seed 10 company listings manually	Cold outreach to 30 startups in your network. Offer first 3 months free.	Day 22–28
7	Build no-code MVP	Bubble or Webflow + Airtable. Student profile, job board, company dashboard. Ship fast.	Day 22–30
8	Set seed funding target	\$300K–\$500K. Approach EdTech-focused angels after 1,000 active users.	Day 30–60

9	Define 3 north-star metrics	Track: weekly active students, company listings live, successful matches made.	Day 1 (ongoing)
10	Set up a legal entity	Register company (LLP or Pvt Ltd in India). Sort IP ownership before co-founder joins.	Day 1–14

14 VALIDATION SCORES



15 FINAL VERDICT

■ STRONG DEMAND SIGNAL — CONDITIONAL GO

DIMENSION	ASSESSMENT
Problem Severity	91% market awareness of the problem. Critical pain on both sides of the marketplace. Timing is ideal — AI wave + Gen Z workforce entry.
Market Size	\$32B TAM with a clear path to \$96M SOM by Year 3 at just 2% SAM capture. Not a niche bet.
Differentiation	No competitor combines: paid-only listings + AI skill matching + global Tier-2/3 access. White space is real.
Key Risk	Execution, not idea. Cold-start problem and absence of a tech co-founder are the two blockers. Both are solvable in 60 days.
Proceed If	You complete 30 customer interviews in 30 days, launch a waitlist in 45 days, and identify a technical co-founder within 60 days.

This report was generated using a VC-grade validation framework based on the InternTrust Idea Validation Report (2025). All projections are indicative and require real-world validation.
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